

# Your House Hunting Scorecard

Compare up to eight homes on what actually matters to you.

## GETTING STARTED

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1. Open **House-Hunting-Scorecard.xlsx** in Microsoft Excel on a desktop computer.
2. If Excel opens it in Protected View, choose **Enable Editing** so the calculations run.
3. Save your own copy and work in that.
4. On **Criteria**, weight what matters to you from 1 to 5. Change the criteria themselves if yours are different.
5. On **Homes**, add each place you see and score it 1 to 5 on every criterion.

**Score each home the day you see it.** By the seventh viewing they blur together, and a score written in the car is worth more than one reconstructed a week later.

## THE FIVE TABS

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- **Criteria** — what matters to you, and how much.
- **Homes** — one row per place, scored against every criterion.
- **Costs** — what each one costs you every month.
- **Results** — every home side by side, with cost per point.
- **Reference** — every term and every assumption.

## BEFORE YOU START

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**Weights are the whole point.** If commute is a 5 and parking is a 2, a home that wins on parking will not beat one that wins on commute. Set the weights honestly before you see anything, while you can still be objective.

**Cost per point is the number to watch.** It divides what a home costs each month by how well it scores. The cheapest home is not always the best value, and the highest scoring one rarely is.

**This does not value a property or estimate a mortgage.** Enter the monthly payment your lender quoted. A spreadsheet guess would be worse than the real number.

## CELL COLORS

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- **Cream cells** — enter your own numbers here.
- **Gray cells** — calculated automatically. Do not type in these.
- **Blue cells** — editable assumptions.